被拒绝了十二次的哈利·波特

The Book Twelve Publishers Turned Down



十二次拒绝后，一位八岁读者带来了什么转机？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In 1990, on a delayed train from Manchester to London's King's Cross, Joanne Rowling, a would-be novelist, was unexpectedly struck by the inspiration for Harry Potter, an orphaned young wizard. Grief soon overshadowed that spark: her mother died on 30 December 1990, aged 45. Rowling then relocated to Porto to teach English.

Rowling married in Porto in October 1992, and a daughter's arrival in July 1993 ushered in motherhood. At the end of 1993 she resettled in Edinburgh, a lone mother reliant on state welfare. She habitually wrote in cafés, patiently polishing her unfinished novel.

A literary agent, Christopher Little, took on the manuscript and pitched it repeatedly to prospective buyers. It was reportedly rejected by twelve publishers in succession, a relentless run of refusals that offered the newcomer little encouragement.

At Bloomsbury, the chairman Nigel Newton gave the first chapter to his eight-year-old daughter, Alice, who relished it and eagerly asked for the next instalment. The firm paid a sum of 1,500 pounds as an advance. Fearful that boys might disregard a book by a woman, the publishers opted for initials to mask her gender. Having no middle name, Rowling took the K for her pseudonym from her grandmother Kathleen.

Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone was published on 26 June 1997, in a cautious first print run of 500 hardbacks, 300 allocated to libraries. The American publisher Scholastic paid $105,000 for the US rights, and the renamed Sorcerer's Stone appeared there on 1 September 1998. The series and its spin-off volumes have collectively surpassed 500 million copies sold, in 80 languages. Alice's appetite was evidently shared by millions.

中文译文

1990年，一列从曼彻斯特驶往伦敦国王十字车站的火车晚点了。车上，想成为小说家的乔安妮·罗琳意外得到灵感，构思出孤儿少年巫师哈利·波特。然而悲痛很快掩盖了这点火花：母亲于1990年12月30日去世，年仅45岁。罗琳随后移居波尔图，教授英语。

罗琳于1992年10月在波尔图结婚，1993年7月女儿降生，她开始为人母。同年年底，她在爱丁堡重新安家，成为依靠国家福利生活的单亲母亲。她常在咖啡馆写作，耐心打磨那部尚未完成的小说。

文学经纪人克里斯托弗·利特尔接下书稿，多次向潜在买家推介。据报道，书稿接连被十二家出版社拒绝。这一连串毫不留情的回绝，几乎没有给这位新人带来鼓励。

布卢姆斯伯里出版社董事长奈杰尔·牛顿把第一章给八岁的女儿爱丽丝看。她读得津津有味，急着要下一部分。出版社支付了1500英镑预付金。担心男孩会忽略女作者的书，出版方选择用名字首字母缩写掩去作者性别。罗琳没有中间名，便从祖母凯瑟琳的名字中取来K，组成笔名的一部分。

《哈利·波特与魔法石》于1997年6月26日出版，第一批精装本谨慎地只印了500册，其中300册分配给图书馆。美国学乐出版社花10.5万美元买下美国版权；更换英文书名后的美版于1998年9月1日问世。这一系列及衍生图书后来已有80种语言版本，合计销量超过五亿册。显然，数百万读者和爱丽丝有着同样的阅读胃口。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

inspiration n.
灵感
the inspiration for Harry Potter

grief n.
悲痛
Grief soon overshadowed that spark

overshadow v.
使黯然失色；盖过
overshadowed that spark

relocate v.
移居
relocated to Porto

usher in 动词短语
开启；带来
ushered in motherhood

reliant on 形容词短语
依靠
reliant on state welfare

welfare n.
政府福利救济
state welfare

polish v.
润色；打磨
polishing her unfinished novel

literary adj.
文学的
A literary agent

pitch v.
推介；推销
pitched it repeatedly

prospective adj.
潜在的；可能成为的
prospective buyers

reject v.
拒绝
rejected by twelve publishers

in succession 介词短语
接连；连续
twelve publishers in succession

relish v.
十分享受；津津有味地读
who relished it

disregard v.
忽视
disregard a book by a woman

opt for 动词短语
选择
opted for initials

initial n.
姓名首字母缩写
initials to mask her gender

pseudonym n.
笔名
the K for her pseudonym

hardback n.
精装本
first print run of 500 hardbacks

allocate v.
分配
300 allocated to libraries

collectively adv.
合计；共同地
have collectively surpassed

surpass v.
超过
surpassed 500 million copies sold

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

delay v.（分词作定语）
延误；晚点

Manchester 专名
曼彻斯特

would-be adj.
有志成为的

novelist n.
小说家

unexpectedly adv.
出乎意料地

orphaned adj.
失去父母的；成为孤儿的

wizard n.
巫师

spark n.
火花；灵感的萌芽

arrival n.
降生；到来

motherhood n.
为人母的生活

resettle v.
重新安家

Edinburgh 专名
爱丁堡

lone adj.
独自的；单亲的

habitually adv.
习惯性地；经常

patiently adv.
耐心地

unfinished adj.
尚未完成的

take on 动词短语
接手；接下

repeatedly adv.
多次地

relentless adj.
毫不留情的；持续不断的

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

refusal n.
回绝

newcomer n.
新人

encouragement n.
鼓励

chairman n.
董事长

chapter n.
章

eagerly adv.
急切地

instalment n.
分期的一部分；此指后续章节

a sum of 名词短语
一笔……的款项

as an advance 介词短语
作为预付金

fearful adj.
担心的

mask v.
掩饰；隐瞒

gender n.
性别

cautious adj.
谨慎的

rename v.
更名

series n.
系列

spin-off adj.
衍生的

volume n.
书；卷

appetite n.
阅读欲望；兴趣

evidently adv.
显然

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 It was reportedly _____ by twelve publishers in succession

02 the publishers _____ initials to mask her gender.

03 in a cautious first print run of 500 _____

04 The series and its spin-off volumes have collectively _____ 500 million copies sold, in 80 languages.

文章主线

- 起笔 1990年，罗琳在一列晚点火车上得到哈利·波特的灵感，开始构思孤儿巫师的故事。
- 坚持 经历丧母后，她在爱丁堡独自抚养女儿，依靠福利生活，仍常在咖啡馆打磨小说。
- 转机 书稿据报遭十二家出版社拒绝；布卢姆斯伯里董事长的八岁女儿爱丽丝，读首章后急着看后续。
- 问世 该社接纳书稿，因担心男孩忽略女作者的书，采用J.K.缩写署名；1997年首册《魔法石》在英国首印500册精装本。
- 回响 美国版于1998年问世；系列及衍生图书后来已有80种语言版本，合计销量超过五亿册。

参考答案　1 rejected 2 opted for 3 hardbacks 4 surpassed